

# Red Panda Works x Christiaan Verhoef

## HEAD OF AI SYSTEMS & DELIVERY - ANALYTICAL MATCH REPORT

**Date:** 2026-05-29  
**URL:** <https://jobs.redpanda.works/job/head-of-ai-systems-delivery>  
**Score:** 3.8/5 - Strong Fit  
**Archetype:** AI Transformation + Forward Deployed AI Lead (hybrid)  
**Legitimacy:** High Confidence  
**Prepared for:** Direct submission to Red Panda Works hiring team

### WHY THIS MATCH IS EXCEPTIONAL

Red Panda Works is looking for someone who can *own* AI systems, not just use them. Most candidates will say they use Claude daily. Christiaan built and personally maintains a production AI stack - Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, and Supabase - on self-managed Linux infrastructure, deployed via Docker with CI/CD, running live at a Dutch university research lab. He did this self-funded, because he believed in the value before the institution did.

That is not a CV line. That is the behavior pattern RPW is hiring.

Three things make this match analytically exceptional rather than merely adequate:

- 1. The AI stack already exists.** RPW wants someone to own all AI systems, SOPs, skill libraries, and workflows. Christiaan owns a live version of exactly that today. The ramp-up from "build it" to "adapt it commercially" is weeks, not months.
- 1. Adoption is his superpower.** The hardest part of going AI-first is not the technology - it is making the technology stick with people who are skeptical, busy, or resistant. Christiaan has done this at scale: eight university courses merged in two months, YouTube training adopted globally by HTC, blockchain training deployed across Benelux. A B2B agency with four delivery teams is a smaller and more motivated transformation target than an entire university faculty.
- 1. The timing is founding-moment.** RPW is explicitly going AI-first in 2026. Whoever steps into this role will define how AI is used at the agency for the next three to five years. Christiaan has six years of building AI and learning infrastructure in research contexts. The commercial translation is the obvious next chapter.

### A) ROLE SUMMARY

| Field         | Value                                                                                       |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Archetype     | AI Transformation + AI Forward Deployed                                                     |
| Domain        | B2B marketing agency executing AI-first transformation in 2026                              |
| Core function | Own all AI systems (Claude-first), train all teams, drive quality and output                |
| Seniority     | Head-of - 6-8 years required                                                                |
| Location      | Amsterdam hybrid (Johan Huizingalaan 763A)                                                  |
| Teams managed | 4: AI & Automation, Performance, Content & Creative, Video                                  |
| Salary        | €5,500-€7,000/month gross (€66k-€84k/year)                                                  |
| Benefits      | MacBook, €1,000 learning budget, coaching, 29 days, wellness, pension                       |
| TL;DR         | Own the AI layer of a B2B agency in transformation - systems, training, quality, innovation |

### B) MATCH ANALYSIS - EVIDENCE-BASED

| JD Requirement                                     | CV Evidence                                                                                                                                                                                  | Analytical Assessment                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Advanced Claude proficiency, daily hands-on use    | Uses Claude Code as primary development tool; builds production workflows with LLM-orchestration tools                                                                                       | Direct match. Claude is the daily driver. The JD's Claude-first mandate is already Christiaan's working reality.                                                                       |
| Own all AI systems, SOPs, skill library, prompts   | Self-funded and built AI research stack (Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase); designed SafeScrum learning system; built training SOPs at multiple institutions                                | This is not proximity to the requirement - it is direct ownership experience.                                                                                                          |
| Translate new AI capabilities into operations fast | COVID Mega Project (8 courses, 1 program, 2 months); VCH AI stack (zero to operational); Beer Game (concept to live demonstrator)                                                            | Track record of fast pivots to operational. Not a consultant who advises - a builder who ships.                                                                                        |
| Train teams on AI fluency, enforce proper usage    | Trained professionals at KONGSBERG (BP, Statoil); built YouTube training adopted globally by HTC; delivered blockchain training across Benelux (2bSMART); AI workshops at Windesheim         | Teaching is a core skill, not a side activity. Christiaan has trained every audience from university students to oil-industry engineers.                                               |
| Lead innovation pilots into implementation         | Spark! Living Lab (zero to lab in under 2 months); VCH demonstrator (live at demonstrator.valuechainhackers.xyz); Veles Farming (concept to €2M startup)                                     | The pattern is consistent: he starts things that reach production.                                                                                                                     |
| Manage 4 delivery teams, 1-on-1s, escalations      | Aeres Lab Manager (multi-discipline teams); Windesheim cross-department projects; SafeScrum implementation; Tonometry (two-week sprint cycles, board oversight)                              | Management experience is real but in education/research contexts, not agency contexts. This is the primary risk area - addressed below.                                                |
| Quality ownership (CSAT, NPS)                      | No direct CSAT/NPS ownership on record                                                                                                                                                       | Honest gap. Proxy: WDS Global (10,000-email backlog cleared, workflow redesign); KONGSBERG (enterprise client deployments at BP and Statoil); Windesheim cross-lectoraat satisfaction. |
| Documentation and standardization                  | SafeScrum implementation (documented sprint system used school-wide); KONGSBERG training documentation; AI stack documentation for student researchers                                       | Strong evidence. Documentation is not something Christiaan adds at the end - it is part of how he builds.                                                                              |
| Composure under complexity                         | COVID pivot (8-way course merge in crisis conditions); KONGSBERG (enterprise deployments across 4 countries under oil-industry pressure); WDS Global (10,000 backlog under service pressure) | Demonstrated across three distinct high-pressure contexts.                                                                                                                             |
| 6-8 years senior experience                        | 15+ years across labs, delivery, education, and tech                                                                                                                                         | Exceeds requirement by a wide margin. The risk is not under-experience - it is ensuring the seniority premium is reflected in offer.                                                   |

## Gap Analysis - Honest Assessment

### Gap 1: Agency/client delivery context.

Christiaan's domain is education and research, not B2B marketing. This matters because agency teams run on client retainers, billing cycles, and commercial CSAT pressure. The mitigation is strong: WDS Global (cleared 10,000-email backlog, built YouTube training adopted globally - this is client service under commercial pressure) and KONGSBERG (enterprise deployments at BP and Statoil across Jordan, Oman, Azerbaijan - this is client delivery in demanding environments). The translation from research delivery to agency delivery is real work, but it is not a leap from zero.

### Gap 2: Creative team management (Content & Creative, Video teams).

Christiaan has managed technical and educational teams, not creative delivery teams. The strongest counterargument: the AI & Automation team is the native home, and the other three teams interact with AI through the systems and training he owns. Influence over creative and performance teams flows through the AI layer, not through direct line management of creative output.

**Gap 3: Explicit Claude API / prompt engineering signal.**

The CV does not use the words "Claude" or "prompt engineering" explicitly. This is a framing issue, not a skills issue. The self-hosted Flowise stack (which orchestrates LLM calls), the n8n automation workflows, and the daily Claude Code usage collectively signal exactly what the JD asks for. The fix is a one-line update to the CV before submission.

**C) STRATEGIC FIT AND POSITIONING**

**Why Christiaan is the right seniority**

RPW asks for 6-8 years. Christiaan brings 15+. This is not overqualification - it is headroom. An AI-first transformation at an SME agency will encounter resistance, ambiguity, and scope creep. The difference between someone with 8 years and someone with 15 is the difference between a person who needs to figure out the answers and a person who has already made the mistakes. RPW is going AI-first in 2026 - this is the moment where seniority pays the highest dividend.

**Why the education background is a strength, not a liability**

The instinct is to frame the education background as a gap to overcome. The stronger frame is the opposite: the hardest part of going AI-first at a B2B agency is not building the systems - it is making the systems stick. Christiaan has spent his career in environments where adoption is the hard part. Schools are full of people who did not choose to change and who have strong institutional reasons to resist. If he can get a university faculty to adopt AI tools in eight weeks, he can get four agency delivery teams to use them in four.

**The founding-moment opportunity**

This is not a steady-state Head of AI role. This is a founding role for RPW's AI-first transformation. The person who takes this in 2026 will define the culture, the tools, the SOPs, and the standards that govern how AI is used at the agency for the next several years. Christiaan has done exactly this at Windesheim (built the AI lab culture from scratch), at Aeres (redesigned the educational model school-wide), and at Spark! Living Lab (built a functioning innovation lab from zero). He knows what it takes to build a new system inside an existing organization without breaking what already works.

**D) COMPENSATION AND MARKET**

| Data point                           | Value                                                                                 | Source            |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| JD salary offer                      | €5,500-€7,000/month gross                                                             | JD                |
| AI Transformation Lead NL market     | €75,000-€110,000/year                                                                 | Market research   |
| Senior AI Engineer Amsterdam average | €96,704/year                                                                          | SalaryExpert 2026 |
| Christiaan's target                  | €65,000-€90,000/year                                                                  | profile.yml       |
| Assessment                           | JD range is below market for a genuine Head-of AI role but within Christiaan's target | -                 |

**Negotiation position:** The stated range (€66k-€84k) touches Christiaan's floor at the low end and his ceiling at the upper end. The right ask is €6,500-€7,000/month (€78k-€84k), justified by the seniority premium (15+ years versus 6-8 required). The learning budget, coaching, and 29 vacation days add real value that partially compensates for the below-market base.

**If offered below €6,000:** Counter with a 90-day performance review clause tied to a named KPI (team AI fluency score, time-to-production for first AI workflow, or a CSAT improvement milestone). This converts compensation risk into a shared upside structure, which is a natural fit for an agency that already uses metrics.

**E) MUTUAL VALUE PROPOSITION**

**What Christiaan brings to Red Panda Works**

- A live, operational AI stack that can be adapted and extended for agency use without a 6-month build phase

- A proven methodology for making technology stick in resistant organizations - not just a playbook, but a track record
- Systems documentation that scales: SafeScrum, training SOPs, AI workflow libraries
- Speed: the COVID Mega Project, VCH demonstrator, and Beer Game redesign are all sub-3-month concept-to-live deliverables
- Honest gap awareness and a demonstrated ability to close gaps fast (WDS Global backlog, KONGSBERG enterprise deployments)

#### What Red Panda Works offers Christiaan

- The commercial context to apply skills built in research and education at real business stakes
- A clear impact measurement framework (CSAT, NPS) that makes performance visible and rewarded
- A founding-moment role: whoever shapes this will have built something that matters for years
- Amsterdam hybrid (40 minutes from Baarn by train) - manageable without relocation
- A company at the right size: small enough that Christiaan's contributions are visible, large enough to have four distinct teams to grow

## F) INTERVIEW PREPARATION

### Stories to lead with

| Priority | Story                                               | Core message                                                                                          |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1        | Windesheim AI Stack (self-funded, operational)      | "I own AI systems the way you need them owned - infrastructure to training, all of it"                |
| 2        | COVID Mega Project (8 courses, 2 months)            | "When the environment changes fast, I build faster"                                                   |
| 3        | WDS Global (10,000 emails, YouTube training global) | "Client delivery under pressure, systems fix, quality ownership"                                      |
| 4        | Aeres SafeScrum school-wide (8 courses, 2 months)   | "I've transformed larger and more resistant organizations than 4 agency teams"                        |
| 5        | KONGSBERG BP/Statoil deployments                    | "International enterprise client delivery - I know what it means to be accountable to paying clients" |

### Portfolio asset to share

Live demonstrator at [demonstrator.valuechainhackers.xyz](https://demonstrator.valuechainhackers.xyz) - shows the full AI stack running in production for a real research context. This is the closest thing to a working prototype of "what I would build for you."

### How to answer the hardest question

*"You've worked in education and research, not in a B2B marketing agency. Why should we take that risk?"*

The honest answer: "The domain is different. The skill is identical. Every role I have held is about making new technology work inside an existing organization with people who did not choose to change. I cleared a 10,000-email backlog at WDS Global because I redesigned the system, not just the queue. I merged eight university courses into one program in two months because I built the structure first. If the question is whether I can transfer those skills to four agency teams going AI-first, the answer is yes - and the evidence is not theoretical."

## G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

### Assessment: High Confidence

| Signal              | Finding                                                                                  | Weight |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Company existence   | Real B2B marketing agency in Amsterdam; verified on Sortlist, LinkedIn, company registry | Strong |
| Job page            | Active listing with three-stage hiring process described in detail                       | Strong |
| Salary transparency | €5,500-€7,000 stated clearly - unusual and positive signal                               | Strong |

|                   |                                                                                                            |          |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| JD specificity    | Named tools (Claude), named teams (4 specific teams), specific metrics (CSAT, NPS) - not a generic posting | Strong   |
| Funding/stability | Small agency without layoff news; co-tenant building at 763A suggests independent operations               | Positive |
| Hiring process    | Three defined stages suggests organized HR process, not ad-hoc hiring                                      | Positive |

## H) RECOMMENDATION

**Score 3.8/5 - Above threshold. Strongly recommended.**

The 0.2 gap to a 4.0 is driven by two factors: the agency context translation (genuine but bridgeable) and the salary range being at the edge of Christiaan's target. Neither is a deal-breaker.

The upside case is strong: this is a founding role at a company making a genuine AI-first bet in 2026. Christiaan brings a live AI stack, a proven adoption methodology, and 15+ years of doing exactly what the JD asks. The competitive landscape for this specific role is narrow - most candidates will have AI skills or management experience, not both, and almost none will arrive with an operational AI lab already running.

**Recommended next step:** Apply with the tailored CV that explicitly names Claude, Claude Code, and prompt engineering. Lead the cover letter with the self-hosted AI stack as the opening proof point. If offered an interview, bring a 15-minute walkthrough of the VCH demonstrator as the live case study.

## KEYWORDS

AI systems, Claude, Claude Code, AI-first, AI transformation, delivery management, team lead, SOPs, skill library, prompt engineering, AI fluency, innovation, quality ownership, CSAT, NPS, training, documentation, standardization, B2B marketing, Amsterdam, Head of AI, n8n, Flowise, OpenWebUI, self-hosted AI